
STUDY COMPANION

How to Stop Worrying and Start Living

*Twenty-eight practical principles for replacing
worry with deliberate, useful action*

DALE CARNEGIE
THE COMPLETE BOOK

The Framework

Carnegie does not give you a worldview. He gives you a toolbox. Twenty-eight tools, each forged in the lives of real people who used them to climb out of breakdowns, bankruptcies, prison camps, and slow declines.

What follows organizes those twenty-eight tools as numbered principles. Part Two reorganizes the same wisdom by *when you would use it*: tools for the moment worry strikes, frameworks for thinking it through, and daily practices that build long-term resistance.



PART ONE

The Twenty-Eight Principles

*Each principle is one complete tool —
history, story, lesson, and action.*



01 Live in Day-Tight Compartments

Shut the iron doors on yesterday and tomorrow

"Our main business is not to see what lies dimly at a distance, but to do what lies clearly at hand."

— Thomas Carlyle

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Sir William Osler and the ocean liner

A worried medical student at Montreal General in 1871 read Carlyle's 21 words and went on to organize Johns Hopkins and hold the Regius chair at Oxford. At Yale he told students his "mediocre" brain succeeded only through living in day-tight compartments — borrowed from a captain pressing a button to seal watertight bulkheads on a great liner.

Arthur Hayes Sulzberger paints in the dark

The publisher of the New York Times couldn't sleep at the outbreak of WWII — painting self-portraits at 3 a.m. Peace came when he adopted five words from a hymn: "One step enough for me."

Ted Bengermينو and the hourglass

A graves-registration NCO with the 94th Infantry, 90 pounds, sobbing alone. An Army doctor said: "Think of yourself as an hourglass. One grain of sand at a time." It carried him through the war.

Edward S. Evans gives up — and recovers

Lost everything in a friend's bad note and a bank collapse, given two weeks to live. He stopped struggling, slept for the first time in weeks, and eventually built Evans Products Company — on the NYSE, with a Greenland airfield in his honor.

THE CORE LESSON

The best way to prepare for tomorrow is to concentrate every ounce of your intelligence and enthusiasm on doing today's work superbly today.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Each morning, picture pressing a button to drop the iron doors on yesterday and tomorrow.
2. Take tasks one grain at a time through the narrow neck of the hourglass.
3. Make "today well lived" the only standard you measure yourself against.
4. Plan for tomorrow with intelligence; refuse to feel anxiety about it.

02

Willis Carrier's Magic Formula

Worst case, accept it, then improve on it

"Be willing to have it so. Acceptance of what has happened is the first step in overcoming the consequences of any misfortune."

— William James

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Willis Carrier at Pittsburgh Plate Glass

A \$20,000 gas-cleaning device failing in Crystal City, Missouri. He defined the worst (job loss), accepted it mentally, then found a \$5,000 fix. The firm netted \$15,000.

The blackmailed New York oil dealer

Three sleepless nights over a \$5,000 blackmail demand. He ran the formula Sunday night, accepted ruin, went to his lawyer — who sent him to the DA. The blackmailer was a wanted crook.

Earl P. Haney brings his casket

Ninety pounds, ulcers, two weeks to live. He accepted death, boarded the SS President Adams with a casket in the hold, gained 90 pounds crossing Asia, and came back cured.

THE CORE LESSON

Worry destroys concentration; acceptance restores it. Define the worst, accept it, then your full mind is free to improve the outcome.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Write the worst case down fearlessly and honestly.
2. Commit to accepting it — out loud, on paper.
3. Go to work improving on what you've already accepted.
4. The relief between acceptance and action is where breakthrough thinking appears.

03

What Worry May Do to You

The body keeps the score

"Those who do not know how to fight worry die young."

— Dr. Alexis Carrel, Nobel laureate

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Eight smallpox cases vs. ten thousand times the damage

Two thousand doctors mobilized for eight NYC smallpox cases. Meanwhile worry — causing ten thousand times the damage — got no doorbell ringers at all.

Dr. Gober of the Santa Fe Railway

Told Carnegie that seventy percent of patients could cure themselves if they got rid of their fears and worries.

Merle Oberon at the mirror

Broke in London, living on crackers and water, saw worry forming lines on her face. "The only thing you have to offer is your looks, and worry will ruin them."

Olga Jarvi smiles through cancer

Condemned at Mayo, she took an oath: "I am not going to worry. I am going to win." Forty-nine days of radiation beyond normal dosage. She smiled through every session. Miracle cure.

THE CORE LESSON

Worry produces ulcers, heart disease, hypertension, arthritis, tooth decay, and shortened lives. Fighting worry is not optional; it is medical.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Treat worry as a physical threat, not just an emotional inconvenience.
2. Watch for early warnings: sleeplessness, appetite loss, weight changes.
3. A cheerful attitude is part of the body's actual healing machinery.
4. Face the facts, quit worrying, then do something about it — in that order.

04

The Three-Step Problem Analysis

Get the facts, analyze them, decide and act

"Half the worry in the world is caused by people trying to make decisions before they have sufficient knowledge on which to base a decision."

— Dean Herbert Hawks, Columbia College

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Dean Hawks and Tuesday at 3:00

Helped 200,000 students for 22 years. His method: refuse to decide until the facts are in. By the deadline, the problem usually solves itself.

Galen Litchfield at the Shanghai YMCA

Facing the Japanese Bridge House for hiding \$750K in securities. Typed out four courses of action Sunday afternoon. Chose the calmest. Slept that night. Six weeks later the admiral returned to Tokyo.

Waite Phillips never looks back

The Oklahoma oilman: "There comes a time when we must decide and act and never look back."

THE CORE LESSON

Three steps solve almost any worry: get the facts impartially, analyze them on paper, then decide and act — and never reconsider.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Collect facts as if for someone else — or as a lawyer arguing the opposite side.
2. Write the problem down. A problem well-stated is half-solved.
3. Make the decision, then go into action. Don't re-litigate.
4. Fifty percent of worries vanish at decision; forty more at execution.

05

The Four Questions for Business Worry

Define the problem before solving it

"A problem well stated is a problem half solved."

— Charles Kettering

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Leon Shimkin at Simon & Schuster

Fifteen years of circular conferences. Made a rule: answer four questions on paper before any meeting. 75% of conference time vanished. Most problems solved themselves during the writing.

Frank Bettger discovers his own numbers

About to quit insurance, he pulled 12 months of records: 70% of sales closed on the first call, 23% on the second, only 7% beyond. Cut the tail and doubled his income.

THE CORE LESSON

Force yourself (and anyone bringing a problem) to answer four written questions: What is the problem? What is the cause? What are all possible solutions? Which one do you suggest?

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Demand the problem be stated in writing before any conversation.
2. Insist on root cause, not surface symptoms.
3. List all options, not just the first one.
4. Always bring problems with a recommendation attached.

06

Crowd Worry Out by Keeping Busy

The mind can hold only one thought at a time

"I must lose myself in action, lest I wither in despair."

— Tennyson

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Marion J. Douglas and the toy boat

Two daughters dead in ten months. His four-year-old asked him to build a boat. Three hours of peace. Then 242 home repairs. Two years later he was running the school board.

Osa Johnson in a wheelchair

Husband killed in a Denver plane crash. Doctors said she'd never leave bed. Three months later she lectured a hundred audiences from a wheelchair.

Admiral Byrd alone at the South Pole

Five months on the ice cap, no living thing within 100 miles. Assigned himself hourly tasks each night. "Without purpose, the days would have ended in disintegration."

Tremper Longman's sixteen-hour days

Insomniac over half a million in unsold strawberries, he switched to 16-hour days for three months. The worry disappeared and he slept instantly.

THE CORE LESSON

It is physically impossible for the mind to hold two thoughts at once. A mind full of constructive work has no room for worry.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Keep a running list of projects to deploy when worry threatens.
2. The dangerous hours are after work, when the mind goes idle.
3. When grief or fear strikes, prescribe yourself useful work.
4. Nature abhors a vacuum; an empty mind fills with worry by default.

07

Don't Let the Beetles Get You Down

Life is too short to be little

"Life is too short to be little."

— Disraeli

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Robert Moore at 276 feet under

Submarine Baya, fifteen hours of depth charges, 100° air. He reviewed all the trivial things he'd worried about — bank pay, a forehead scar, arguments with his wife — and promised never to waste time on trifles again.

The 400-year-old tree on Long's Peak

Survived 14 lightning strikes and four centuries of avalanches. Killed by beetles small enough to crush between finger and thumb.

Kipling and Balestier over hay

The man who wrote "If" lost his head over a hayfield. Court in Vermont. Worldwide headlines. Kipling abandoned his American home forever.

Charles Seyfried makes a whistle

An hour in mosquito-infested Teton woods. Instead of cursing he cut an aspen branch and carved a whistle. Carnegie kept it for life.

THE CORE LESSON

Most of us survive the big disasters and get destroyed by the little ones. Refuse to let trifles take what storms could not.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Notice when something tiny is consuming your evening, and call it what it is.
2. Shift emphasis: Homer Croy turned banging radiators into a campfire crackle.
3. Ask: will this matter in a year? If not, it doesn't deserve a year's attention now.
4. The law does not concern itself with trifles. Adopt the same policy.

08

Use the Law of Averages

Examine the record before you worry

"By the law of averages, it won't happen."

— Mrs. Salinger's husband

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Lloyd's of London

Two hundred years profitable by betting that the disasters people fear almost never arrive.

Mrs. Salinger and the tent at 7,000 feet

Eleven years of imagined disasters. Her lawyer husband's calm refrain — "by the law of averages, it won't happen" — destroyed 90% of her worries.

Jim Grant's 25,000 carloads

Only 5 ever wrecked. The odds were 5,000 to 1 against the disaster he'd been imagining.

Frederick Mahlstedt at Omaha Beach

Direct-hit odds on a deep narrow trench: less than 1 in 10,000. He built a roof and slept.

THE CORE LESSON

Almost nothing you worry about will actually happen. Before sinking another hour into fear, examine the actual probability.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Pull your own data: how often has this actually happened?
2. Insurance companies are profitable proof that feared disasters rarely arrive.
3. Make it a verbal habit: what are the odds?
4. When the math contradicts the worry, side with the math.

09

Cooperate with the Inevitable

When you can't change it, accept it

"God grant me the serenity to accept the things I cannot change, the courage to change the things I can, and the wisdom to know the difference."

— Reinhold Niebuhr

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Booth Tarkington loses his sight

Named the floaters "Grandfather," endured twelve operations under local anesthetic, refused a private room. "I would not exchange this experience for a happier one."

Sarah Bernhardt at 71

Told her leg must be amputated. "If it has to be." Recited a play scene on the way to surgery — "to cheer up the doctors." Toured seven more years.

Elizabeth Connelly carries on

Lost her nephew in WWII. Found his old letter: "I know you'll carry on." She did — and said it was the fullest life she'd ever known.

William Cassellius on a ton of TNT

A cracker salesman drafted to supervise explosives at Caven Point, NJ. After an hour of terror: "So you're blown up. So what? You won't know the difference."

THE CORE LESSON

Some things are so and cannot be otherwise. The energy you spend rebelling against the inevitable is stolen from building the life that remains.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Identify what's genuinely beyond your control and verbally accept it.
2. Bend like the willow, not the oak — Carnegie's trees broke under ice because they refused to flex.
3. The Niebuhr prayer is a daily diagnostic: which am I dealing with?
4. Acceptance is not surrender; it's redirection of finite energy.

10

Put a Stop-Loss Order on Your Worries

Decide in advance how much a worry is worth

"The cost of a thing is the amount of what I call life which is required to be exchanged for it."

— Thoreau

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Charles Roberts and Burton Castles

Every stock purchase at \$50 gets an automatic sell at \$45. Limit the loss to five points. Roberts extended the idea to a chronically late lunch partner: ten-minute stop-loss.

Gilbert and Sullivan over a carpet

The composers of HMS Pinafore stopped speaking forever over a theater carpet bill. Mailed music and lyrics separately. Bowed in opposite directions on curtain calls.

Carnegie's novel, *The Blizzard*

Two years in Europe writing a novel his agent called worthless. He set a stop-loss, dumped the manuscript, and wrote non-fiction instead.

Tolstoy's fifty-year diary war

Each spouse wrote the other as villain. The home Tolstoy himself called a lunatic asylum. No stop-loss on a marital grievance.

THE CORE LESSON

Decide in advance how much emotional cost a problem is worth, and refuse to spend more. The currency is life, not dollars.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Set a deliberate cap on how much life any one worry gets.
2. Apply the stop-loss to resentments and grudges especially.
3. Before re-engaging, ask: have I already spent more than this is worth?
4. What does this whistle cost me in life-energy?

11

Don't Try to Saw Sawdust

Don't cry over spilt milk

"Wise men ne'er sit and wail their loss, but cheerily seek how to redress their harms."

— Shakespeare

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Dr. Brandwine smashes a bottle of milk

In front of his hygiene class at George Washington High School. "That milk is gone. All the fussing in the world won't bring back a drop." The student remembered it the rest of his life.

George Washington Carver: "Yes, I heard"

Lost \$40,000 — a lifetime's savings — in a bank crash. Went back to teaching and never mentioned it again.

Jack Dempsey opens a restaurant

Lost the title to Tunney, knew by round ten he was finished. Didn't dwell. Built Jack Dempsey's on Broadway. "I've had a better time in the last ten years than when I was champion."

Connie Mack at 81

"You can't grind any grain with water that has already gone down the creek."

THE CORE LESSON

The past cannot be changed. The only constructive use of a past mistake is to extract the lesson and walk away.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Treat a past mistake like an experiment: extract the data, close the file.
2. Catch yourself re-litigating something already settled — and stop.
3. The moving finger writes, and having writ, moves on.
4. Replace "why did I do that?" with "what does that teach me next?"

12

Eight Words That Can Transform Your Life

Our life is what our thoughts make it

"Our life is what our thoughts make it."

— Marcus Aurelius

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Lowell Thomas with a flower in his buttonhole

Broke in London, eating at Lyons Corner House on borrowed money. Every morning he bought a fresh flower, pinned it to his coat, and walked Oxford Street head high. Concerned but not worried.

Dr. Hadfield's grip test

Three men averaged 101 lbs normally, 29 lbs hypnotized to feel weak, 142 lbs hypnotized to feel strong. Bodies unchanged — only beliefs.

The Florida student and the camera lens

Nervous breakdown, fled to Miami. Father's letter: "You took with you the cause of all your trouble — yourself." Church sermon: "He who conquers his spirit is mightier." Went home, married the girl, now manages 450 people.

THE CORE LESSON

**Your circumstances do not determine your experience — your mental attitude does.
Choose your thoughts and you choose your life.**

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. You can change feelings by changing actions — the feeling follows (William James).
2. Throw back your shoulders, smile, hum. You can't stay gloomy while acting happy.
3. Distinguish concern (constructive) from worry (circling). Allow the first; refuse the second.
4. Try Sybil Partridge's "Just for Today" program — ten one-day commitments.

13

The High Cost of Getting Even

Hating an enemy gives them power over you

"When you try to get even, you hurt yourself more than you hurt the other fellow."

— Milwaukee Police Department

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

The grizzly and the skunk

In Yellowstone, the grizzly could kill the skunk with one swipe. He let it eat beside him. It wasn't worth it.

William Falkaber dies over a coffee saucer

A 68-year-old cafe owner chased his cook with a revolver because the cook drank from a saucer. Fell dead from heart failure mid-pursuit.

George Rona thanks the rude man

A Vienna lawyer exiled in Sweden got a brutal rejection letter. Instead of a scorching reply, he wrote a thank-you. Days later, the man offered him a job.

Edith Cavell forgives the firing squad

Last words before execution: "I must have no hatred or bitterness toward anyone."

Lawrence Jones nearly hanged

Standing on kindling with a rope around his neck, he spoke about his school. A Confederate veteran said "We ought to help him," and passed a hat — \$52.40 from the mob.

THE CORE LESSON

Resentment is the worst trade. You pay with sleep, blood pressure, face, and joy — and the enemy gets it all for free.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Hating someone hurts you, not them.
2. Forgiveness is the smart play — protection of your own scarce resources.
3. Eisenhower's rule: never waste a minute on people you don't like.
4. Get absorbed in a cause bigger than your grievances.

14

Expect Ingratitude — Give for the Joy

Gratitude is cultivated, not natural

"Gratitude is a fruit of great cultivation. You do not find it among gross people."

— Samuel Johnson

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

The Texas businessman's \$10,000

Eleven months still burning over Christmas bonuses to 34 employees — not one thank-you. Wasting a year of his remaining life on a lesson in human nature he refused to learn.

Leibowitz saves 78 men

Kept 78 men off the electric chair. Zero thank-yous, zero Christmas cards.

Aunt Viola in Minneapolis

Raised six children plus two grandmothers. Twenty years a widow, five households compete to host her. The warmth she breathed out for decades came back on its own.

THE CORE LESSON

Forgetting to thank is human nature. Give expecting gratitude and you'll be perpetually disappointed; give for joy and you'll be perpetually fulfilled.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Treat any thanks as a delightful surprise, never as the price owed.
2. Give for the inner joy of giving. That joy is the return.
3. Model gratitude for your children: praise others' kindness out loud.
4. The loneliest people are those who give only to extract.

15

Count Your Blessings, Not Your Troubles

Think and thank

"I had the blues because I had no shoes, until upon the street I met a man who had no feet."

— Persian saying

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Harold Abbott in Webb City, Missouri

Walking to the bank after his grocery store closed, he saw a legless man on a roller-skate platform smile and say: "Morning, sir. Fine morning, isn't it?" He asked for twice the loan and got it.

Eddie Rickenbacker's Pacific raft

"If you have all the fresh water you want to drink and all the food you want to eat, you ought never to complain."

Borghild Dahl washes dishes

Near-blind for 50 years. After a Mayo Clinic operation, she found ecstasy in soap bubbles at the kitchen sink. Her book: *I Wanted to See*.

THE CORE LESSON

About 90 percent of your life is going right. Spend your attention on the 90 and you'll be largely happy; spend it on the 10 and you'll be largely miserable.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Each morning, name five specific things you're grateful for.
2. Inventory what you'd refuse to sell for any amount: eyes, legs, children, hearing.
3. Schopenhauer's warning: we seldom think of what we have, but always of what we lack.
4. Write "Think and Thank" where you'll see it daily.

16

Find Yourself and Be Yourself

Imitation is suicide

"Envy is ignorance. Imitation is suicide."

— Emerson

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Edith Allred's accidental remark

Shy, overweight, suicidal from trying to fit her in-laws' mold. Overheard her mother-in-law: "I always insisted on their being themselves." Rebuilt her life from the ground up.

Berlin tells Gershwin to stay himself

"If you insist on being yourself, someday you'll be a first-rate Gershwin."

Cass Daly opens her mouth

Protruding teeth, ashamed. A nightclub man: "Those teeth may make your fortune." They did.

Carnegie writes the wrong book twice

Years lost imitating other authors and other actors. Only succeeded when he was himself.

THE CORE LESSON

You are a one-in-300-billion genetic event. Trying to be someone else wastes that uniqueness and guarantees a worse copy.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Identify the trait you've been hiding — consider whether it's your asset.
2. Stop measuring yourself against paths never available to you.
3. Cultivate your own little garden.
4. "If you can't be a pine on the hill, be the best little scrub by the side of it."

17

Make Lemonade from Lemons

Turn your minus into a plus

"When you have a lemon, make a lemonade."

— Julius Rosenwald

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Thelma Thompson at the Mojave Desert

125°, sand in everything, ready to quit. Father's two-line letter: "Two men looked out from prison bars. One saw the mud, the other saw the stars." She learned Navajo weaving, studied yuccas, wrote a novel.

The Florida rattlesnake farmer

Useless land, nothing but scrub oak and rattlesnakes. He canned the meat, sold the venom, sold the skins. 20,000 tourists a year. The post office renamed itself Rattlesnake, Florida.

Ben Fortson in the Atlanta elevator

Both legs gone at 24. Read 1,400 books. Became Georgia's Secretary of State. "I am almost glad it happened."

Al Smith never finishes grade school

Studied 16 hours a day for 10 years, became the best authority on NY state government, four-term governor, presidential candidate, honorary degrees from Columbia and Harvard.

THE CORE LESSON

Every misfortune carries the seeds of its own offset. The skill is asking "what can I learn?" instead of "why me?"

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Force the question within 24 hours: what can I learn from this?
2. The constraint often IS the asset — Darwin, Milton, Beethoven.
3. Even if you can't reverse the situation, looking for the lesson redirects you forward.
4. The north wind made the Vikings.

18

Forget Yourself by Serving Others

You can be cured in fourteen days

"You can be cured in fourteen days if you follow this prescription: try to think every day how you can please someone."

— Alfred Adler

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

C.R. Burton, the orphan who became beloved

Mother abandoned him, father killed in a car wreck, raised on a stranger's farm. Mrs. Lofton told him: "They won't call you an orphan brat if you get interested in them." He helped classmates write essays, cut wood for widows. When he returned from the Navy, 200 farmers drove as far as 80 miles to welcome him home.

Dr. Frank Loup and the Shut-In Society

An invalid for 23 years with arthritis. Instead of complaining, he wrote 1,400 letters a year to other invalids, organized a national letter-writing club, and got radios and books for shut-ins across the country.

Margaret Taylor Yates at Pearl Harbor

A heart patient who spent 22 hours a day in bed. When the bombs hit, the Red Cross asked her to track families by phone. She sat up, then stood up, then never went back to bed. "The attack on Pearl Harbor was one of the best things that ever happened to me."

Mrs. William Moon on Christmas Eve

Widowed and drowning in self-pity, she wandered into a church and fell asleep. Two orphaned children woke her up. She bought them candy and presents. Her loneliness vanished. "These two orphans did far more for me than I did for them."

THE CORE LESSON

Thinking about others forces you to stop thinking about yourself — and self-absorption is the fuel worry runs on. A good deed every day is Adler's prescription for mental health.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Every day, do one thing that puts a smile on someone else's face.
2. Interest in others is not optional kindness — it is the mechanism that breaks the worry circuit.
3. Ask the postman, the barber, the grocery worker how their day is going — and mean it.
4. Carl Jung: one third of his patients suffered from the senselessness of their own lives. Service fills that void.

19

The Power of Prayer and Faith

The perfect way to conquer worry

"Prayer is the most powerful form of energy one can generate. It is a force as real as gravity."

— Dr. Alexis Carrel

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Carnegie's father on the bridge

After 30 years of floods, cholera, debt, and humiliation, his father stood on a bridge over the 102 River debating whether to jump. He didn't, because of his wife's abiding faith that if they loved God and kept his commandments, everything would come out all right. He lived 42 more years, to 89.

John R. Anthony in Amarillo

A law-book salesman so broke he drank hot milk for dinner, afraid to enter prospects' offices. One night he read the Gideon Bible: "Seek ye first the kingdom of God." The next morning he marched in with confidence. Sales zoomed. "I was born anew that desperate night."

Mary Cushman and the gas heater

Eighteen dollars a week, five children, a grocer accusing her son of stealing. She turned on the gas. A hymn on the radio saved her: "What a friend we have in Jesus — all our sins and griefs to bear." She jumped up, turned off the gas, and poured out thanks for five healthy children.

Admiral Byrd alone on the ice

Poisoned by carbon monoxide in his stove, too weak to leave his bunk, certain he would die. He wrote in his diary: "The human race is not alone in the universe." The realization pulled him through. "There are deep wells of strength that are never used."

THE CORE LESSON

Prayer fulfills three psychological needs: it forces you to put your problem into words, it gives you a sense of not being alone, and it sets an active principle of doing in motion.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Even if you are not religious, putting your worry into words — to God or to a journal — clarifies it.
2. The sense of shared burden is therapeutic. Few of us are strong enough to carry the heaviest loads alone.
3. Prayer, like all clear expression, is the first step toward action.
4. William James: "Faith is one of the forces by which men live. The total absence of it means collapse."

20 No One Ever Kicks a Dead Dog

Unjust criticism is often a disguised compliment

"Remember that no one ever kicks a dead dog."

— The elder Hutchins, to his son at age 30

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Robert Maynard Hutchins at 30

Inaugurated as president of the University of Chicago while older educators denounced him as too young and too radical. His father's reply to a stinging editorial: "Remember that no one ever kicks a dead dog."

The Prince of Wales at Dartmouth

Fourteen years old and crying because the cadets kicked him. Why? They wanted to be able to say, when they became captains, that they had kicked the king.

Admiral Perry at the North Pole

Lost eight toes to frostbite, nearly went insane. His naval superiors in Washington tried to block him out of jealousy. Only a direct order from President McKinley kept him going.

General Grant arrested after his greatest victory

Won the first great decisive battle of the Civil War in one afternoon, became a national idol overnight. Six weeks later he was arrested and his army taken from him — because his superiors were jealous.

THE CORE LESSON

The more important you become, the more you will be criticized. Unjust criticism is often proof that you have aroused jealousy and envy.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. When someone attacks you, ask: am I being kicked because I'm accomplishing something?
2. Vulgar people take huge delight in the faults of great men — Schopenhauer.
3. Jefferson was called a threat to virtue. Washington was jeered in the streets. It comes with the territory.
4. If no one is criticizing you, you may not be doing enough.

21 Put Up Your Umbrella

Do the best you can and let the rain run off

"If the end brings me out all right, then what is said against me won't matter. If the end brings me out wrong, then ten angels swearing I was right would make no difference."

— Abraham Lincoln

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

General Smedley Butler's 30 years of hide

"I have been berated, denounced as a yellow dog, a snake, and a skunk. I have been cursed by the experts. Words in the English language no longer bother me."

Eleanor Roosevelt's Rock of Gibraltar

Teddy Roosevelt's sister told her: "Never be bothered by what people say as long as you know in your heart you are right." Eleanor's own rule: "You'll be damned if you do and damned if you don't."

Matthew Brush stops pleasing everyone

Trying to pacify every critic at his corporation only created new enemies. "If you get your head above the crowd, you're going to be criticized. So get used to it."

Lincoln's literary gem

Hung above MacArthur's headquarters desk and Churchill's study at Chartwell: "I do the very best I know how, the very best I can, and I mean to keep on doing so until the end."

THE CORE LESSON

You cannot stop unjust criticism, but you can determine whether it disturbs you. Do the best you can and let the rain run off.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Half the people who read the criticism never saw it; half who saw it forgot in a week.
2. People are thinking about themselves, not about you — before breakfast, after breakfast, and until midnight.
3. One of Jesus's 12 closest friends betrayed him for \$19. Don't expect a better score.
4. Do your best. Then put up the umbrella.

22

Keep an FTD Folder

Be your own most severe critic

"Every man is a damn fool for at least five minutes a day. Wisdom consists in not exceeding that limit."

— Elbert Hubbard

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Carnegie's own filing cabinet

A folder marked FTD — Fool Things I've Done. Written records of his own blunders, sometimes too embarrassing to dictate. "They help me deal with the toughest problem I'll ever face — the management of Dale Carnegie."

H.P. Howell's Saturday night review

The chairman of the Commercial National Bank spent every Saturday evening reviewing the week's appointments, asking: what mistakes did I make? What did I do right? How could I improve? He credited this practice more than anything else for his success.

Darwin spends 15 years criticizing himself

After completing the manuscript of *Origin of Species*, he became his own critic for another 15 years — checking data, challenging reasoning, criticizing conclusions — before publishing.

E.H. Little asks for punches

A struggling Colgate soap salesman who, after failing to close a sale, would go back and ask the merchant: "Won't you tell me what I did wrong? Be frank. Don't pull your punches." He became president of Colgate-Palmolive-Peet.

THE CORE LESSON

Instead of waiting for enemies to criticize you, beat them to it. Find your own weaknesses before anyone else does.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Keep an FTD file — write down your blunders and review them periodically.
2. Do a weekly self-review like H.P. Howell: what worked, what didn't, what would I do differently?
3. When criticism arrives, ask: could this be right? If Einstein admits 99% error, your percentage can't be much better.
4. Invite constructive criticism — then use it. The opinions of our enemies come nearer to the truth than our own.

23

Rest Before You Get Tired

Add one hour a day to your waking life

"Rest is not a matter of doing absolutely nothing. Rest is repair."

— Daniel W. Joselyn

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Churchill's three naps

In his late 60s and early 70s, directing the British Empire's war effort 16 hours a day. He worked in bed until 11 a.m., slept an hour after lunch, and slept two hours before dinner at 8. He didn't cure fatigue; he prevented it.

Rockefeller's noon couch

Not even the President of the United States could get John D. on the phone during his midday nap. He lived to 98.

Schmidt and the pig iron

Frederick Taylor's Bethlehem Steel experiment: laborers loaded 12.5 tons a day. Under a system of 26 minutes of work and 34 minutes of rest per hour, one man loaded 47 tons. He rested more than he worked and did four times the output.

Your heart's secret

The heart pumps enough blood to fill a railway tank car every 24 hours. At 70 beats per minute, it actually rests 15 hours out of 24. It rests before it gets tired.

THE CORE LESSON

Fatigue accumulates with astonishing speed. Rest before you get tired and you will add one hour a day to your waking life.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. A five-minute nap helps more than you think — Connie Mack couldn't last a double-header without one.
2. Do what your heart does: rest between beats, not only at the end of the day.
3. An hour's nap before dinner plus six hours of sleep does more good than eight hours straight.
4. It's cheaper than a cocktail and over a long stretch 5,467 times more effective.

24

Learn to Relax While You Work

Most fatigue comes from emotions, not effort

"The greater part of the fatigue from which we suffer is of mental origin. Exhaustion of purely physical origin is rare."

— Dr. A.J. Hadfield

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Blood from Einstein's brain

Scientists found zero fatigue toxins in blood drawn from working brains. The brain itself is tireless at the end of twelve hours. What tires you is not the work but the emotional attitude around it.

Vicki Baum's circus clown

As a child she fell and hurt herself. An old circus clown picked her up and said: "You don't know how to relax. Pretend you are as limp as a sock. An old crumpled sock." She used the image for the rest of her life.

The maroon sock on Carnegie's desk

He kept an old limp sock on his desk as a visual reminder of how relaxed he should be. "If you haven't got a sock, a cat will do. I never saw a tired cat, a cat with a nervous breakdown, or a cat suffering from insomnia."

THE CORE LESSON

One hundred percent of the fatigue of sedentary workers is emotional: boredom, resentment, frustration, hurry, anxiety. Relax your muscles and the worry cannot sustain itself.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Start with your eyes: close them and say "let go, let go" for one minute. That is the whole secret.
2. Check yourself four times a day: am I tensing muscles that have nothing to do with this task?
3. Think of yourself as an old crumpled sock — Vicki Baum's circus clown advice.
4. Tension is a habit. Relaxation is a habit. Bad habits can be broken.

25

Talk It Out

The healing power of words

"Brooding over worries alone and keeping them to oneself causes great nervous tension. We have to share our troubles."

— Dr. Rose Hilverding, Boston Dispensary

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

The Boston Dispensary class

Dr. Joseph Pratt discovered that patients with no physical basis for their symptoms — arthritis, stomach cancer, chronic fatigue — could be healed by talking their troubles out. Thousands cured over decades. One woman attended for nine years.

The woman with the worry list

A domestic-troubles patient arrived wound tight as a spring. As she talked, she gradually calmed. By the end she was smiling. The problem hadn't changed. The act of voicing it had.

Five home practices from the clinic

Keep an inspirational scrapbook. List your spouse's virtues. Get interested in strangers. Schedule tomorrow's work tonight. Relax on the floor like a crumpled sock.

THE CORE LESSON

Talking your troubles out to a trusted person provides almost instant relief. Freud knew it. Modern psychiatry proves it. The healing power lies in the words themselves.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. Find one person you trust and say: I want your advice. Then talk it out.
2. You don't need a therapist for this — a relative, a friend, a minister will do.
3. Keep an inspirational scrapbook of poems, prayers, and quotes for rainy afternoons.
4. When you catch yourself brooding alone, that's the signal to share, not to stew.

26

Four Good Working Habits

Clear desk, prioritize, decide now, delegate

"Order is heaven's first law."

— Alexander Pope — painted on the ceiling of the Library of Congress

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Dr. Sadler's clean desk

A Chicago executive was heading for a breakdown. Watching Sadler handle three interruptions instantly — phone, second call, colleague — he said: "In ten minutes I've got a hunch as to what's wrong with me." Six weeks later: one desk, no piles, recovered health.

Charles Luckman's 5 a.m. planning

The Pepsodent president who made a million besides his salary credited it to two abilities: the ability to think, and the ability to do things in the order of their importance.

H.P. Howell at US Steel

Board meetings dragged for hours, members carried home bundles of unsettled reports. Howell persuaded them to take up one problem at a time and decide before moving on. The calendar cleared overnight.

Frank Bettger plans the night before

Set a sales goal each night. If he missed, the shortfall was added to the next day's target.

THE CORE LESSON

Four habits prevent the "sense of must" that breeds anxiety: clear your desk of everything except the immediate task, do things in the order of their importance, solve problems on the spot when you have the facts, and learn to organize, deputize, and supervise.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. A cluttered desk breeds confusion, tension, and the false feeling of being overwhelmed.
2. Plan the day's priorities each evening — Bernard Shaw wrote five pages a day for nine years this way.
3. Don't carry unsettled problems home. Decide or defer, but don't dangle.
4. Delegate or die early. Executives who can't let go pop off with heart trouble in their fifties.

27

Make Boring Work Interesting

Boredom causes more fatigue than hard labor

"Boredom is the only real cause of diminution of work."

— Dr. Edward Thorndike, Columbia

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Alice dances until 3 a.m.

Came home from work utterly exhausted — headache, backache, wanted to skip dinner. Then the boyfriend called with a dance invitation. She danced until 3 a.m. and came home exhilarated. The fatigue was not physical; it was boredom.

The Tulsa stenographer who raced herself

Filling out dull oil-lease forms each month, she turned it into a daily contest: beat yesterday's count. She became the fastest in her division. The fatigue disappeared. "I happen to know this is true," Carnegie wrote, "because I married that girl."

H.V. Kaltenborn sells stereoscopes in Paris

At 22, no French, pasted his sales talk in his hat, shrugged "an American!" when questioned. Every morning he gave himself a pep talk in the mirror: "You have to do this to eat. So why not have a good time doing it?" Earned \$5,000 in commissions that year.

Sam Vauclain races the mechanic

Bored turning bolts at a lathe, he challenged the mechanic beside him to a speed contest. The foreman noticed. Thirty years later he was president of Baldwin Locomotive Works.

THE CORE LESSON

Your emotional attitude causes more fatigue than physical effort. Interest kills fatigue. If you act as if you are interested in your job, the interest tends to become real.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. When stuck with dull work, turn it into a contest with yourself or a colleague.
2. Give yourself a pep talk every morning — it is the essence of sound psychology, not childish nonsense.
3. Remind yourself: you spend half your waking hours at work. If you don't find interest there, you may never find it.
4. Getting interested in your job reduces fatigue, eliminates worry, and often leads to promotion.

28 Stop Worrying About Insomnia

It's the worry that kills, not the sleeplessness

"No one was ever killed by lack of sleep. Worrying about insomnia usually causes far more damage than sleeplessness."

— Dr. Nathaniel Kleitman, University of Chicago

KEY STORIES & EXAMPLES

Samuel Untermyer's lifelong insomnia

Never got a decent night's sleep. Instead of tossing, he studied. Became one of the highest-paid lawyers in America. Earned a million-dollar fee for a single case. Lived to 81.

Ira Sandner's cure

Eight weeks of total insomnia from obsessing over an alarm clock. His doctor said: "If you can't sleep, forget it. Say to yourself: I don't care if I lie awake till morning. As long as I'm lying still, I'm getting rest." In two weeks he was sleeping eight hours.

Herbert Spencer's snoring

The philosopher swore he "never slept a wink" at a hotel. His roommate Professor Sacy hadn't slept a wink either — kept awake all night by Spencer's snoring.

Dr. Henry Link's prescription

A suicidal patient was told: "Run around the block until you drop dead." By the third night he was so physically exhausted he slept like a log. He joined an athletic club and soon wanted to live forever.

THE CORE LESSON

Worrying about insomnia is far more damaging than insomnia itself. No one has ever died from lack of sleep. The body will force sleep long before it kills you.

WHAT TO DO WITH THIS

1. If you can't sleep, get up and work or read. That's what Untermyer and Edison did.
2. Tell yourself: I don't care if I stay awake. As long as I'm lying still, I'm getting rest.
3. Try prayer, or relax your muscles starting with your eyes: "let go, let go."
4. If all else fails, exhaust yourself physically. Nature will force sleep that no willpower can resist.



PART TWO

The Action Guide

*The same wisdom, reorganized by
when you need to reach for it.*



PHASE 1

Immediate Interventions

When worry strikes — what to do in the next sixty minutes.

Shut the Iron Doors

From Principle 01

The moment a worry hits, picture pressing a button that drops a bulkhead on yesterday and tomorrow. Your job for the next hour is the work in front of you.

Run the Carrier Formula in Three Lines

From Principle 02

Open a notepad. Line one: the absolute worst that can happen is... Line two: I accept that. Line three: the way I improve on the worst is... The relief between lines two and three is where real thinking returns.

Get Busy on Something Constructive

From Principle 06

The mind can't hold two thoughts at once. Pick something that requires active planning — a repair, a call, a chapter. Not consumption. Building.

Act Cheerful Before You Feel It

From Principle 12

Shoulders back, real smile, hum or whistle. William James proved the feeling follows the action. Lowell Thomas walked Oxford Street broke, every morning, with a flower in his lapel.

Write the Four Questions

From Principle 05

Problem, cause, solutions, recommendation. Most problems solve themselves during the writing.

Do Something for Someone Else

From Principle 18

Alfred Adler's 14-day prescription. Ask the postman about his day. Compliment the person behind the counter. Self-absorption is the fuel worry runs on. Cut the supply.

Pray or Journal the Worry

From Principle 19

Putting the worry into words — to God, to paper, to a trusted friend — clarifies it and releases the pressure of carrying it alone. The words themselves begin the healing.

PHASE 2

Analytical Frameworks

When the worry has stuck around. Sit down with paper.

Collect Facts as a Lawyer for the Other Side

From Principle 04

When worried, your emotions stack the evidence. Counter it: collect every fact that argues against your preferred view. Write both columns. Truth lives between them.

Examine the Actual Record

From Principle 08

In your own past similar situations, how often did the worst case occur? Jim Grant checked 25,000 carloads: only 5 ever wrecked. The worry vanished.

Set the Stop-Loss

From Principle 10

Before re-engaging, decide the limit. How many minutes, days, or dollars does this worry get? Without a stop-loss you'll trade more life than it's worth.

Check If You're Sawing Sawdust

From Principle 11

Is this about something already done? The only move is to extract the lesson and close the file.

Apply the Niebuhr Diagnostic

From Principle 09

Changeable or inevitable? If changeable, summon courage and act. If inevitable, summon serenity and accept. Most paralysis comes from confusing the two.

Keep an FTD Folder

From Principle 22

Write down your own blunders. Review them weekly like H.P. Howell. When criticism arrives, check: could it be right? Darwin spent 15 years criticizing his own manuscript before publishing.

Use the Four Working Habits

From Principle 26

Clear the desk. Do things in priority order. Decide on the spot when you have the facts. Delegate.

PHASE 3

Daily Practices

Habits that build long-term resistance to worry.

Count Blessings Before News

From Principle 15

First action of the day: name five specific things you have. Not abstractions. The legs you walked on. The water you drank. The person you slept beside.

Refuse Minutes on Enemies

From Principle 13

Eisenhower's rule: never waste a minute thinking about people you don't like. Hang up internally every time.

Despise the Trifles

From Principle 07

When stuck in mosquito-infested woods, make a whistle. The daily trifles will kill most of us, not the big disasters. Say it aloud: life is too short for this.

Give Without Expecting Thanks

From Principle 14

Carnegie's parents sent money yearly to an orphanage they never visited. The joy was in the giving. Notice when you're keeping score — that's the moment to stop.

Rest Before You're Tired

From Principle 23

Churchill napped three times a day during the war. A five-minute nap helped Connie Mack survive a double-header. Do what your heart does: rest between beats.

Relax Your Eyes and Your Muscles

From Principle 24

Close your eyes and say let go for one minute. Check four times a day: am I tensing muscles that have nothing to do with this task? Think of yourself as an old crumpled sock.

Make Boring Work Interesting

From Principle 27

Turn the dull task into a contest. Give yourself a pep talk. You spend half your waking hours at work — finding interest there is half the battle for happiness.

Be Unapologetically Yourself

From Principle 16

Each week, notice one place you were performing instead of being yourself. Try the authentic version in a low-stakes setting. First-rate you beats second-rate anyone.

Squeeze Every Lemon

From Principle 17

When something bad happens, force the question within 24 hours: what can I learn from this? The north wind made the Vikings. The constraint often is the asset.

Accept What You Cannot Sleep Away

From Principle 28

If sleep won't come, don't fight it. Get up and work, or lie still and say: I don't care. The worry about insomnia does the damage, not the insomnia itself.

Quick Reference

One principle per line. Tear out, pin up, glance often.

- 01. LIVE IN DAY-TIGHT COMPARTMENTS.** Concentrate everything on today; seal off yesterday and tomorrow.
- 02. WILLIS CARRIER'S MAGIC FORMULA.** Worst case → accept it → calmly improve on it.
- 03. WHAT WORRY MAY DO TO YOU.** Worry is physically destructive; fighting it is a survival skill.
- 04. THE THREE-STEP PROBLEM ANALYSIS.** Get the facts → analyze on paper → decide and act, then don't look back.
- 05. THE FOUR QUESTIONS FOR BUSINESS WORRY.** Make every problem answer four written questions before it gets discussed.
- 06. CROWD WORRY OUT BY KEEPING BUSY.** Stay so busy with constructive work that worry can't get a foothold.
- 07. DON'T LET THE BEETLES GET YOU DOWN.** Don't let the beetles take what the storms couldn't.
- 08. USE THE LAW OF AVERAGES.** Run the numbers before you run the worry.
- 09. COOPERATE WITH THE INEVITABLE.** Stop fighting what cannot be changed; redirect that energy.
- 10. PUT A STOP-LOSS ORDER ON YOUR WORRIES.** Cap the price you're willing to pay — in life — for any worry.
- 11. DON'T TRY TO SAW SAWDUST.** Extract the lesson from the past, then close the file.
- 12. EIGHT WORDS THAT CAN TRANSFORM YOUR LIFE.** Act cheerful and you'll feel cheerful; the feeling follows the action.
- 13. THE HIGH COST OF GETTING EVEN.** Resentment costs you sleep, health, and joy — the enemy pays nothing.
- 14. EXPECT INGRATITUDE — GIVE FOR THE JOY.** Give for the joy of giving; treat any thanks as a bonus.
- 15. COUNT YOUR BLESSINGS, NOT YOUR TROUBLES.** Count the 90 percent that's right before you fret the 10 percent that's wrong.
- 16. FIND YOURSELF AND BE YOURSELF.** Be yourself — a first-rate you beats a second-rate anyone else.
- 17. MAKE LEMONADE FROM LEMONS.** Ask what this lemon teaches you, then squeeze it.
- 18. FORGET YOURSELF BY SERVING OTHERS.** Please someone else every day and you'll cure yourself in the process.
- 19. THE POWER OF PRAYER AND FAITH.** Unburden your worry — in words, to a power greater than yourself or simply to paper.
- 20. NO ONE EVER KICKS A DEAD DOG.** Unjust criticism is often proof you're doing something worth noticing.
- 21. PUT UP YOUR UMBRELLA.** Do the very best you can, then let criticism run off your back.
- 22. KEEP AN FTD FOLDER.** Beat your critics to it — be your own harshest reviewer first.

- 23. REST BEFORE YOU GET TIRED.** Rest before you're tired, like your heart does — 15 hours out of every 24.
- 24. LEARN TO RELAX WHILE YOU WORK.** The brain is tireless; it's the emotional tension around the work that exhausts you.
- 25. TALK IT OUT.** Share the worry with someone you trust; the words themselves begin the healing.
- 26. FOUR GOOD WORKING HABITS.** Clear the desk. Prioritize. Decide now. Delegate.
- 27. MAKE BORING WORK INTERESTING.** Interest kills fatigue. Act interested and the real interest follows.
- 28. STOP WORRYING ABOUT INSOMNIA.** No one was ever killed by insomnia. The worry about it is what does the damage.